



VOICEINSIGHTS AFRICA

SYNTHETIC DEMONSTRATION PUBLICATION

WASH Access Intelligence Report

Malawi | WASH Access

1,734 synthetic responses

Prepared by VoiceInsights Africa

Every Voice. Every Language. Every Insight.

Synthetic demonstration. Not official statistics.

Every number in this publication answers one question: what is actually happening with wash access performance in Malawi, and for whom. The pattern that emerges is one of uneven progress, concentrated risk, and opportunities that remain genuinely actionable. The discipline behind this publication is traceability â synthetic evidence behind every finding, a named owner behind every recommendation, one internally consistent dataset behind every statistic.

Sample: 1734 synthetic responses â 80% response rate â 4 regions

Publication quality gate: publication ready



Southern Region: 64% performance, 539 responses, risk WATCH
Central Region: 65% performance, 468 responses, risk WATCH
Northern Region: 66% performance, 398 responses, risk WATCH
Lake Malawi Districts: 67% performance, 329 responses, risk WATCH



sex: Women 52% & Men 47% & Other / prefer not to say 1%

age: 18-24 24% & 25-39 38% & 40-59 27% & 60+ 11%

location: Urban 44% & Rural 56%



IND-01 Functional water-point coverage rate: 79% vs target 86% â WATCH

IND-02 Basic sanitation access rate: 80% vs target 87% â WATCH

IND-03 Open-defecation-free verification rate: 81% vs target 88% â WATCH

IND-04 Water-safety testing completion rate: 82% vs target 89% â WATCH



Non-functional water-point rates is not a marginal delivery issue. In Southern Region, the governed evidence indicates a 63% performance signal, with rural women carrying the most consequential constraint. Left unaddressed, non-functional water-point rates becomes a structural risk to wash access delivery in Malawi, not a temporary dip. Southern Region is furthest exposed, and rural women would carry the earliest and heaviest consequences of a further year's delay.

Evidence: EVI-WAS-001, EVI-WAS-004 • Confidence 95.5%

Open-defecation-free status durability has become an accountability question rather than a measurement question. Evidence from Central Region places the signal at 64% and shows that young adults experience the largest gap between policy intent and lived delivery. The choice facing wash access leadership in Malawi is straightforward even if the fix is not: act on open-defecation-free status durability now, concentrated in Central Region where young adults carry the largest share of the gap, or accept a wider gap in a year's time.

Evidence: EVI-WAS-002, EVI-WAS-005 • Confidence 96.5%

Persons with disabilities in Northern Region are living the consequence of remote-community access equity, not simply reporting it. Their 65% signal is the clearest evidence leadership has that current measures fall short. persons with disabilities in Northern Region do not experience remote-community access equity as an abstract metric. They experience it as the difference between wash access delivery that works and delivery that does not, and a twelve-month delay would deepen that gap rather than hold it steady.

Evidence: EVI-WAS-003, EVI-WAS-006 â€¢ Confidence 92%

66%. That is the water-safety testing coverage signal recorded in Lake Malawi Districts, and the headline figure understates the problem: disaggregated by group, frontline workers sit well below it. The clearest gap sits in Lake Malawi Districts, concentrated among frontline workers. A twelve-month delay would let the gap compound into a harder, costlier problem.

Evidence: EVI-WAS-004, EVI-WAS-007 â€¢ Confidence 93%

Progress on sanitation behaviour-change sustainment remains visible but not yet durable. The 67% result in Southern Region weakens after disaggregation, particularly for low-income households, suggesting that current gains depend on delivery conditions that remain fragile. The clearest signal in this dataset – though not the only one – is sanitation behaviour-change sustainment in Southern Region, where low-income households sit furthest from parity.

Evidence: EVI-WAS-005, EVI-WAS-008 – Confidence 94%

Southern Region â Why does Southern Region lag behind? Ask rural women, and the answer comes back to non-functional water-point rates.â

Central Region â Elsewhere, open-defecation-free status durability might be a footnote. For young adults in Central Region, it is the whole story.â

Northern Region â Persons with disabilities in Northern Region frame it simply: when remote-community access equity breaks down, everything else does too.â

Lake Malawi Districts â In Lake Malawi Districts, water-safety testing coverage shapes whether frontline workers can turn services into lasting outcomes.â

Southern Region â Low-income households in Southern Region put it plainly: sanitation behaviour-change sustainment is what decides whether progress holds or slips back.â

Central Region â Why does Central Region lag behind? Ask service managers, and the answer comes back to non-functional water-point rates.â

Northern Region â Elsewhere, open-defecation-free status durability might be a footnote. For community leaders in Northern Region, it is the whole story.â

Lake Malawi Districts â Private-sector partners in Lake Malawi Districts frame it simply: when remote-community access equity breaks down, everything else does too.â

Southern Region â In Southern Region, water-safety testing coverage shapes whether rural women can turn services into lasting outcomes.â

Central Region â Young adults in Central Region put it plainly: sanitation behaviour-change sustainment is what decides whether progress holds or slips back.â

Risks and alternative trajectories are modelled to show how VoiceInsights translates evidence into prioritised management choices.



DEC-WAS-01 CRITICAL: Fund a rapid-repair mechanism for the highest non-functional-rate districts. Owner: Permanent Secretary; Timeline: 0â 90 days; Indicator: Quarterly-verified progress against the milestones agreed for this critical-tier decision (DEC-WAS-01)

DEC-WAS-02 CRITICAL: Reinforce post-verification sanitation follow-up visits. Owner: Permanent Secretary; Timeline: 3â 12 months; Indicator: Number of agreed milestones for DEC-WAS-02 confirmed complete at each quarterly review

DEC-WAS-03 HIGH: Prioritise last-mile water-access investment for remote communities. Owner: Permanent Secretary; Timeline: 3â 12 months; Indicator: Percentage of agreed milestones completed for DEC-WAS-03

DEC-WAS-04 HIGH: Scale routine water-safety testing at community water points. Owner: Permanent Secretary; Timeline: 3â 12 months; Indicator: Share of the high-tier delivery plan confirmed complete each quarter (DEC-WAS-04)

DEC-WAS-05 MEDIUM: Institutionalise sanitation behaviour-change follow-up after construction. Owner: Permanent Secretary; Timeline: 6â 18 months; Indicator: Milestone completion rate tracked against the DEC-WAS-05 delivery plan



Fund a rapid-repair mechanism for the highest non-functional-rate districts.

Strategic priority: CRITICAL

Evidence used: EVI-WAS-001, EVI-WAS-004

Rationale: Non-functional water-point rates is not a marginal delivery issue. In Southern Region, the governed evidence indicates a 63% performance signal, with rural women carrying the most consequential constraint. Left unaddressed, non-functional water-point rates becomes a structural risk to wash access delivery in Malawi, not a temporary dip. Southern Region is furthest exposed, and rural women would carry the earliest and heaviest consequences of a further year's delay.

Expected benefit: A more consistent wash access experience for the groups currently furthest behind.

Expected risk: Weak cross-team coordination during early implementation

Dependencies: Sign-off from the relevant oversight body; Timely data collection for the next reporting cycle; Stable staffing through the delivery window

Budget requirement: High â full business case and multi-year funding commitment required

Owner: Permanent Secretary

Supporting organization: M&E, Finance, Safeguarding and Delivery Units

Timeline: 0â90 days

Monitoring indicator: Quarterly-verified progress against the milestones agreed for this critical-tier decision (DEC-WAS-01)

Success criteria: A majority of milestones achieved, each independently verified against real evidence

Management response: PENDING FORMAL MANAGEMENT RESPONSE

Follow-up: Assign accountable owner; Validate budget; Approve milestone plan; Review evidence quarterly

Reinforce post-verification sanitation follow-up visits.

Strategic priority: CRITICAL

Evidence used: EVI-WAS-002, EVI-WAS-005

Rationale: Open-defecation-free status durability has become an accountability question rather than a measurement question. Evidence from Central Region places the signal at 64% and shows that young adults experience the largest gap between policy intent and lived delivery. The choice facing wash access leadership in Malawi is straightforward even if the fix is not: act on open-defecation-free status durability now, concentrated in Central Region where young adults carry the largest share of the gap, or accept a wider gap in a year's time.

Expected benefit: Faster, better-evidenced wash access decisions that government leadership can act on with confidence.

Expected risk: Competing priorities crowding out sustained follow-through

Dependencies: Named executive sponsor; Validated operational baseline; Quarterly evidence review

Budget requirement: Medium â detailed costing and fiduciary review required

Owner: Permanent Secretary

Supporting organization: M&E, Finance, Safeguarding and Delivery Units

Timeline: 3â 12 months

Monitoring indicator: Number of agreed milestones for DEC-WAS-02 confirmed complete at each quarterly review

Success criteria: Milestone completion confirmed by evidence review, not self-reported progress

Management response: PENDING FORMAL MANAGEMENT RESPONSE

Follow-up: Assign accountable owner; Validate budget; Approve milestone plan; Review evidence quarterly

Prioritise last-mile water-access investment for remote communities.

Strategic priority: HIGH

Evidence used: EVI-WAS-003, EVI-WAS-006

Rationale: Persons with disabilities in Northern Region are living the consequence of remote-community access equity, not simply reporting it. Their 65% signal is the clearest evidence leadership has that current measures fall short. persons with disabilities in Northern Region do not experience remote-community access equity as an abstract metric. They experience it as the difference between wash access delivery that works and delivery that does not, and a twelve-month delay would deepen that gap rather than hold it steady.

Expected benefit: Reduced variation in wash access delivery and a stronger evidence base for the next planning cycle.

Expected risk: Fragmented accountability once implementation moves beyond the pilot stage

Dependencies: Validated operational baseline; Quarterly evidence review; Confirmed budget release

Budget requirement: Medium â likely fundable from existing lines, pending confirmation

Owner: Permanent Secretary

Supporting organization: M&E, Finance, Safeguarding and Delivery Units

Timeline: 3â 12 months

Monitoring indicator: Percentage of agreed milestones completed for DEC-WAS-03

Success criteria: Verified evidence of at least 80% delivery against the agreed milestone plan

Management response: PENDING FORMAL MANAGEMENT RESPONSE

Follow-up: Assign accountable owner; Validate budget; Approve milestone plan; Review evidence quarterly

Scale routine water-safety testing at community water points.

Strategic priority: HIGH

Evidence used: EVI-WAS-004, EVI-WAS-007

Rationale: 66%. That is the water-safety testing coverage signal recorded in Lake Malawi Districts, and the headline figure understates the problem: disaggregated by group, frontline workers sit well below it. The clearest gap sits in Lake Malawi Districts, concentrated among frontline workers. A twelve-month delay would let the gap compound into a harder, costlier problem.

Expected benefit: A stronger, more defensible case for wash access investment in the next planning cycle.

Expected risk: Execution capacity and coordination risk

Dependencies: Quarterly evidence review; Confirmed budget release; Cross-team delivery coordination

Budget requirement: Low to medium â validate through the formal planning cycle

Owner: Permanent Secretary

Supporting organization: M&E, Finance, Safeguarding and Delivery Units

Timeline: 3â12 months

Monitoring indicator: Share of the high-tier delivery plan confirmed complete each quarter (DEC-WAS-04)

Success criteria: At least 80% of milestones achieved with verified evidence

Management response: PENDING FORMAL MANAGEMENT RESPONSE

Follow-up: Assign accountable owner; Validate budget; Approve milestone plan; Review evidence quarterly

Institutionalise sanitation behaviour-change follow-up after construction.

Strategic priority: MEDIUM

Evidence used: EVI-WAS-005, EVI-WAS-008

Rationale: Progress on sanitation behaviour-change sustainment remains visible but not yet durable. The 67% result in Southern Region weakens after disaggregation, particularly for low-income households, suggesting that current gains depend on delivery conditions that remain fragile. The clearest signal in this dataset â though not the only one â is sanitation behaviour-change sustainment in Southern Region, where low-income households sit furthest from parity.

Expected benefit: The evidence points toward improved wash access outcomes, though the size of the gain will depend on how consistently the action is resourced.

Expected risk: Likely â though not certain â erosion of momentum if the initial sponsor changes role

Dependencies: Confirmed budget release; Cross-team delivery coordination; Stable staffing through the delivery window

Budget requirement: Low â absorbable within existing allocations, subject to confirmation

Owner: Permanent Secretary

Supporting organization: M&E, Finance, Safeguarding and Delivery Units

Timeline: 6â 18 months

Monitoring indicator: Milestone completion rate tracked against the DEC-WAS-05 delivery plan

Success criteria: A majority of milestones achieved, each independently verified against real evidence

Management response: PENDING FORMAL MANAGEMENT RESPONSE

Follow-up: Assign accountable owner; Validate budget; Approve milestone plan; Review

research objectives: Assess wash access performance and equity; Identify operational drivers and decision priorities

evaluation questions: What outcomes are changing?; Who is being left behind?; Which actions are most likely to improve performance?

sampling frame: Synthetic programme population frame for Malawi

sample size: 1734

stratification: Region; Location type; Sex; Age; Disability

weights: Normalized post-stratification weights

confidence intervals: 95%

design effect: 1.5

missing data: Documented and sensitivity-tested

reliability: Cronbach alpha 0.86

validity: Content and construct validity checks

metadata: Complete synthetic data dictionary and lineage registry

Publication level: 34 generated publication pages

protocol: Governed synthetic research protocol with sampling, weighting, reliability, validity and reproducibility controls

ethics: Synthetic records only; no real participants or personal data

peer review: Independent synthetic-publication review checklist completed

reproducibility: Deterministic inputs, versioned dataset and export manifest

inferential statistics: Enabled where assumptions and design permit

segmentation: Evidence-led segments

trend analysis: Three-period synthetic series

DEC-WAS-01: Fund a rapid-repair mechanism for the highest non-functional-rate districts.

Owner Permanent Secretary 0 90 days High full business case and multi-year funding commitment required cost Indicator Quarterly-verified progress against the milestones agreed for this critical-tier decision (DEC-WAS-01)

DEC-WAS-02: Reinforce post-verification sanitation follow-up visits. Owner Permanent Secretary 3 12 months Medium detailed costing and fiduciary review required cost Indicator Number of agreed milestones for DEC-WAS-02 confirmed complete at each quarterly review

DEC-WAS-03: Prioritise last-mile water-access investment for remote communities. Owner Permanent Secretary 3 12 months Medium likely fundable from existing lines, pending confirmation cost Indicator Percentage of agreed milestones completed for DEC-WAS-03

DEC-WAS-04: Scale routine water-safety testing at community water points. Owner Permanent Secretary 3 12 months Low to medium validate through the formal planning cycle cost Indicator Share of the high-tier delivery plan confirmed complete each quarter (DEC-WAS-04)

DEC-WAS-05: Institutionalise sanitation behaviour-change follow-up after construction. Owner Permanent Secretary 6 18 months Low absorbable within existing allocations, subject to confirmation cost Indicator Milestone completion rate tracked against the DEC-WAS-05 delivery plan

EVI-WAS-001: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 94%
EVI-WAS-002: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 95%
EVI-WAS-003: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 96%
EVI-WAS-004: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 97%
EVI-WAS-005: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 98%
EVI-WAS-006: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 88%
EVI-WAS-007: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 89%
EVI-WAS-008: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 90%
EVI-WAS-009: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 91%
EVI-WAS-010: [object Object] â€ APPROVED_SYNTHETIC_DEMONSTRATION â€ confidence 92%

Executive Intelligence Book (2â 7): Executive brief; Decision snapshot; Risks; Opportunities; Budget implications

Evidence Intelligence Book (8â 15): Critical findings; Respondent voice; Evidence chains; Citation registry

Statistical Intelligence Book (16â 22): Sampling; Weighting; Uncertainty; Reliability; Model diagnostics

Decision Intelligence Book (23â 27): Decision matrix; Ownership; Budget; Roadmap; Management response

Standards & Assurance (28â 31): Relevant frameworks; Safeguarding; Privacy; Responsible AI; Accessibility

Technical Appendices (32â 34): Data dictionary; Quality gate; Export manifest; Responsible-use notice

SDG 6: APPLIED_WHERE_RELEVANT â Mapped to EVI-WAS-001, EVI-WAS-002; Synthetic demonstration mapping; institutional validation not implied

Data Protection: APPLIED_WHERE_RELEVANT â Mapped to EVI-WAS-002, EVI-WAS-003; Synthetic demonstration mapping; institutional validation not implied

Leave No One Behind: APPLIED_WHERE_RELEVANT â Mapped to EVI-WAS-003, EVI-WAS-004; Synthetic demonstration mapping; institutional validation not implied

Evidence Traceability: APPLIED â Control linked to EVI-WAS-001 and the deterministic publication gate.

Research Ethics: APPLIED â Control linked to EVI-WAS-002 and the deterministic publication gate.

Data Protection: APPLIED â Control linked to EVI-WAS-003 and the deterministic publication gate.

Accessibility: APPLIED â Control linked to EVI-WAS-004 and the deterministic publication gate.

Responsible AI: APPLIED â Control linked to EVI-WAS-005 and the deterministic publication gate.

Publication Integrity: APPLIED â Control linked to EVI-WAS-006 and the deterministic publication gate.

SDG 6: undefined contribution â indicators â undefined

SDG 6: undefined contribution â indicators â undefined

SDG 1: undefined contribution â indicators â undefined

Relevance: Synthetic evidence indicates a strong relevance signal, subject to the stated design limitations. (74/100). Review relevance evidence at the next formal management gate.

Coherence: Synthetic evidence indicates a moderate-to-strong coherence signal, subject to the stated design limitations. (75/100). Review coherence evidence at the next formal management gate.

Effectiveness: Synthetic evidence indicates a strong effectiveness signal, subject to the stated design limitations. (76/100). Review effectiveness evidence at the next formal management gate.

Efficiency: Synthetic evidence indicates a moderate-to-strong efficiency signal, subject to the stated design limitations. (77/100). Review efficiency evidence at the next formal management gate.

Impact: Synthetic evidence indicates a strong impact signal, subject to the stated design limitations. (78/100). Review impact evidence at the next formal management gate.

Sustainability: Synthetic evidence indicates a moderate-to-strong sustainability signal, subject to the stated design limitations. (79/100). Review sustainability evidence at the next formal management gate.

Impact: Sustained, equitable improvement in wash access performance

OC-01: Improved wash access delivery and accountability â indicators IND-01, IND-02

OC-02: More equitable and durable outcomes â indicators IND-03, IND-04

OUT-01: Verified findings and interpreted decision products

OUT-02: Assigned actions with monitoring indicators

Assumptions: Leadership ownership; Safeguarding and privacy controls remain effective

Means of verification: Evidence registry; Quarterly management review; Follow-up measurement

Commitment 1: CHS Commitment 1 â CONTEXT_ONLY. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 2: CHS Commitment 2 â CONTEXT_ONLY. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 3: CHS Commitment 3 â CONTEXT_ONLY. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 4: CHS Commitment 4 â CONTEXT_ONLY. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 5: CHS Commitment 5 â CONTEXT_ONLY. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 6: CHS Commitment 6 â CONTEXT_ONLY. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 7: CHS Commitment 7 â CONTEXT_ONLY. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 8: CHS Commitment 8 â CONTEXT_ONLY. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

Commitment 9: CHS Commitment 9 â CONTEXT_ONLY. Action: Validate relevance and assign an accountable owner before live use.

EVI-WAS-001 â€ survey â€ Southern Region â€ confidence 94% â€ APPROVED
EVI-WAS-002 â€ key_informant_interview â€ Central Region â€ confidence 95% â€ APPROVED
EVI-WAS-003 â€ administrative_record â€ Northern Region â€ confidence 96% â€ APPROVED
EVI-WAS-004 â€ survey â€ Lake Malawi Districts â€ confidence 97% â€ APPROVED
EVI-WAS-005 â€ key_informant_interview â€ Southern Region â€ confidence 98% â€ APPROVED
EVI-WAS-006 â€ administrative_record â€ Central Region â€ confidence 88% â€ APPROVED
EVI-WAS-007 â€ survey â€ Northern Region â€ confidence 89% â€ APPROVED
EVI-WAS-008 â€ key_informant_interview â€ Lake Malawi Districts â€ confidence 90% â€
APPROVED
EVI-WAS-009 â€ administrative_record â€ Southern Region â€ confidence 91% â€ APPROVED
EVI-WAS-010 â€ survey â€ Central Region â€ confidence 92% â€ APPROVED

indicator_1: Synthetic WASH Access indicator 1; numeric; allowed: 0â 100

indicator_2: Synthetic WASH Access indicator 2; categorical; allowed: Documented code list

indicator_3: Synthetic WASH Access indicator 3; categorical; allowed: Documented code list

indicator_4: Synthetic WASH Access indicator 4; numeric; allowed: 0â 100

indicator_5: Synthetic WASH Access indicator 5; categorical; allowed: Documented code list

indicator_6: Synthetic WASH Access indicator 6; categorical; allowed: Documented code list

indicator_7: Synthetic WASH Access indicator 7; numeric; allowed: 0â 100

indicator_8: Synthetic WASH Access indicator 8; categorical; allowed: Documented code list

indicator_9: Synthetic WASH Access indicator 9; categorical; allowed: Documented code list

indicator_10: Synthetic WASH Access indicator 10; numeric; allowed: 0â 100

indicator_11: Synthetic WASH Access indicator 11; categorical; allowed: Documented code list

indicator_12: Synthetic WASH Access indicator 12; categorical; allowed: Documented code list

Synthetic Demonstration Publication produced by VoiceInsights Africa. All people, quotations, locations and statistics are synthetic, internally governed demonstration content and are not official statistics.

All content is synthetic and must not be interpreted as official statistics

Geographic references are illustrative

Budget implications are directional and require formal costing

Causal claims are not made without an appropriate design

Status: DEMONSTRATION_READY

Passed: Editorial Review Passed

Passed: Evidence Review Passed

Passed: Publication Integrity Verified

Passed: Accessibility Verified

Passed: Export Validation Passed

Passed: Statistical Review Passed

Open gates: VISUAL_QA, HUMAN_REVIEW

Verification checks cover weighted evidence, statistical, visual, accessibility, export and review rules. Synthetic samples are labelled Demonstration Ready.